

The ICT Lounge



Year 7

Year 8

IGCSE

A-Level

I.B

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Section 7.7: Stage 5 - Documentation

Once the new system has been developed, **two sets** of documentation needs to be produced for the following reasons:

- To record exactly how the system was created
- To explain how to use the system.

The first set of documentation is known as **technical documentation** and the second set is known as **user documentation**.

Key Concepts of this section:

- # Understand what is meant by **System Documentation**.
- # Know the **difference** between **technical documentation** and **user documentation**.
- # Be able to **describe** the **differences** between the two sets of documentation.

Stage 5 - Documentation

What is system documentation?

- # System documentation **explains** how the system was **created** and also **how to use it**.
- # **Two sets** of documentation are produced for a new system, for the following reasons:

Technical documentation



Technical documentation is produced for the benefit of **future developers of the system**.

This explains how the system was **developed** and includes information such as **hardware and software requirements, file structures** and **coding** used.

(Click this link [here](#) for more information)

User documentation



User documentation is produced for the benefit of the **intended users of the system**.

This explains **how to use the new system** and will include information such as how to **log into the system, how to save files** and **how to print** system data.

(Click this link [here](#) for more information)

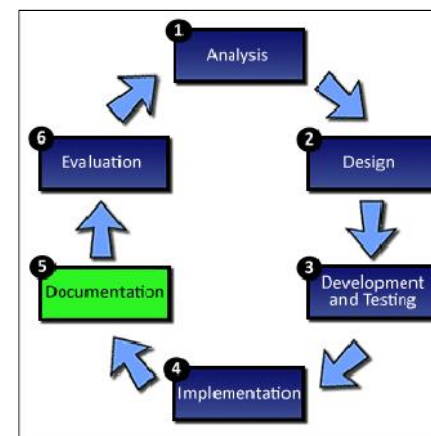
- # Both types of system documentation are discussed in more detail below:



Key Words:

Technical documentation, User documentation.

Examples:



Documentation takes place during the fifth stage of the systems lifecycle.

1 Technical Documentation

Why is technical documentation needed?

- # Technical documentation is created for the benefit of **analysts, designers** and **programmers** who may work on the system in the **future**.
- # Technical documentation explains **exactly** how the system was **created**.

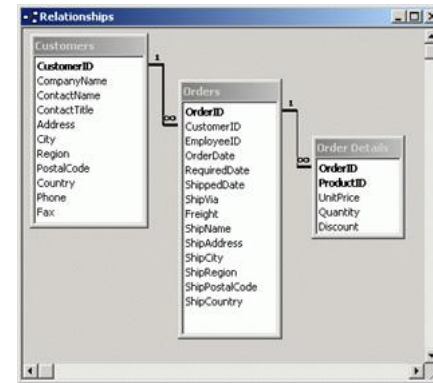
Technical documentation covers every aspect of the system's development in **minute detail**.

- # This gives future analysts, designers and programmers the **knowledge** needed to **maintain/repair/improve** the system.

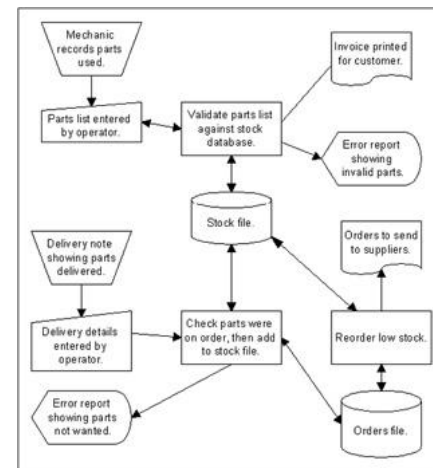
What is included in technical documentation?

- # Technical documentation consists of the following information:
 - **The purpose of the system** - description of the problem that the system solves
 - **Hardware requirements** - listing of hardware needed to run the system (processor speeds, minimum hard disk capacity etc.)
 - **Software requirements** -
 - **Memory (RAM) requirements** - what is the lowest and recommended amount of RAM needed to run the system?
 - **Copies of all system designs** - designs for input screens and output screens will be described in terms of sizing, layout and colour schemes etc.
 - **Copies of system flow charts** - these show how data will flow through the new system
 - **Explanations of file structures (tables) used** - this will include table's field names, data types and how tables are linked (in relational database)
 - **The programming language used to code the system** - this will make it easier to hire competent programmers in the future (hire people who know the language)
 - **Listings of the code** - how the code joins together and annotations that explain what the code does etc.
 - **Details of system bugs** - fixing known bugs would be a priority of future work done on the system
 - **User interface designs** - descriptions of what each form control (text box, check box etc.) is used for
 - **Input formats** - what kind of data will the system accept?
 - **Output formats** - what kind of data can the system produce? What does it look like?
 - **Validations rules used** - description of each error control method and the reasons behind including each one
 - **Meanings of errors messages** - descriptions of what system error messages mean and how to remedy the error
 - **Testing information (test plans, test data used and results)** - information on how each system module was tested and the outcome of the test.

Examples:



How system database tables are linked will be shown and described in technical documentation.
(Click image to zoom)



How data travels around the system would be described using flow charts. (Click image to zoom)

```
function app = simpleStockTicker
% This is the "constructor" for the class
% It runs when an object of this class is created
app.Figure = figure('Name','none'); % Main figure
app.Ticks = axes('Parent',app.Figure,... % Axes for prices
    'Position',[10 10 70 70]);
app.TicksTitle = uicontrol(app.Figure,... % 'Symbol' label
    'Style','text','Position',[20 20 50 20],...
    'String','Symbol');
app.TicksEdit = uicontrol(app.Figure,... % Symbol edit box
    'Style','text','Position',[70 20 90 20],...
    'String',app.TicksTitle,...
    'Callback', @app.symbolUpdateCallback);

prices = NaN(ones(1,app.NumValues)); % Initialize prices
app.Line = plot(app.Axes,prices,'Marker',...
    'r','LineStyle','-');
xlabel(app.Axes,'Stock value (i)');
set(app.Axes,'TitleLabel','');
title(app.Axes,['Stock Price: ' app.TicksTitle])
```

2 User Documentation

Why is user documentation needed?

- # User documentation is created for the **benefit** of anyone who is expected to **use the system**.
- # User documentation explains **exactly** how to **use** the new system

User documentation is essentially a **training manual** that helps people **learn** the new system.

What is included in user documentation?

- # User documentation consists of the following information:
 - **The purpose of the system** - explains what the system can be used for
 - **Hardware requirements** - listing of hardware the user needs to run the system
 - **Operating system required** - which operating systems can be used to run the system (Windows, Mac OS etc.)
 - **How to open/load the system**
 - **How to log in and log out of the the system**
 - **How to search for system data**
 - **How to input new data**
 - **How to amend data**
 - **How to sort data**
 - **How to save files**
 - **How to print files**
 - **How to handle system errors / The meaning of error messages** - user documentation will describe what has caused the error and how it can be solved
 - **Frequently asked questions (FAQs)** - known problems or questions that users may have will be described here along with the answers that go with them
 - **Trouble shooting guides** - these tell the user how to identify what has gone wrong with the system and what can be done about it
 - **Help guides / Tutorials** - these help the user learn how to use the main features of the system.

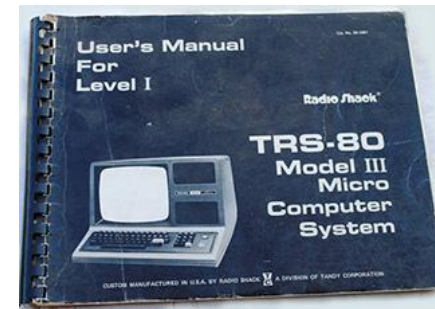
Activity!

[The Documentation Stage - Research Sheet](#)

Click the above task and answer the questions about the Documentation Stage.

System coding is included and described using annotations. (Click to zoom)

Examples:



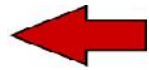
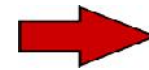
A user guide for an old computer system.

PC SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS	
MINIMUM	RECOMMENDED
• Windows 7 SP1 / Vista SP2 • Intel Core 2 Duo @ 1.8 Ghz (AMD Athlon II X2 240 or equivalent processor) • 1 GB RAM • nVidia GeForce7800 / ATI Radeon X1300 / Intel HD Graphics 2000 • DirectX 9.0c Compatible Video card with 512MB • 8GB free HDD space	• Windows 7 SP1 / Vista SP2 • Intel Core i3 530 • (AMD Phenom II X4 925 or equivalent processor) • 2 GB RAM • nVidia GeForce7950 / ATI Radeon HD 2400 / Intel HD Graphics 3000 • DirectX 9.0c Compatible Video card with 1024MB • 8GB free HDD space
SUPPORTED CHIPSETS: • nVidia: GeForce GTX Titan, GTX 780, GTX 680, GTX560TI, GTX470, GTX285, 9800, 8800, 8800, 7950, 7950, 7800, 7300, 6800 • ATI: Radeon R9 270X, HD 7950, HD 6870, HD5850, HD5770, HD4870, HD4860, HD3870, HD2600, HD2400, X1900, X1650, X1600, X1300 • Intel: HD Graphics 4600, HD Graphics 4000, HD Graphics 3000, HD Graphics 2500, HD Graphics 2000	

Hardware/software and operating system requirements will be shown in user documentation. (Click image to zoom)



Error message are explained in user documentation. This error message shows an error with the system


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